



Life Under the Sun - 08.30.26

Pastor Mark Schilling

Ecclesiastes 1:1-11(ESV)

The words of the Preacher, the son of David, king in Jerusalem.

2 Vanity of vanities, says the Preacher,
vanity of vanities! All is vanity.

3 What does man gain by all the toil
at which he toils under the sun?

4 A generation goes, and a generation comes,
but the earth remains forever.

5 The sun rises, and the sun goes down,
and hastens to the place where it rises.

6 The wind blows to the south
and goes around to the north;
around and around goes the wind,
and on its circuits the wind returns.

7 All streams run to the sea, but the sea is not full;
to the place where the streams flow, there they flow again.

8 All things are full of weariness; a man cannot utter it;
the eye is not satisfied with seeing, nor the ear filled with hearing.

9 What has been is what will be, and what has been done is what will be done,
and there is nothing new under the sun.

10 Is there a thing of which it is said, "See, this is new"?
It has been already in the ages before us.

11 There is no remembrance of former things,
nor will there be any remembrance
of later things yet to be among those who come after.



1. LIFE IS A VAPOR

Ecclesiastes 1:1-3(NIV)

The words of the Teacher, son of David, king in Jerusalem:

2 “**Meaningless! Meaningless!**”

says the Teacher.

“Utterly meaningless!

Everything is **meaningless.**”

3 What do people gain from all their labors
at which they toil under the sun?

The Hebrew hevel(meaningless) literally means vapor, breath, mist.

Ecclesiastes 1:11

No one remembers the former generations,
and even those yet to come
will not be remembered
by those who follow them.



2. LIFE IS CYCLICAL AND MEANINGLESS WITHOUT GOD

Ecclesiastes 1:4-7(NIV)

Generations come and generations go,
but the earth remains forever.

5 The sun rises and the sun sets,
and hurries back to where it rises.

6 The wind blows to the south
and turns to the north;
round and round it goes,
ever returning on its course.

7 All streams flow into the sea,
yet the sea is never full.

To the place the streams come from,
there they return again.

3. Meaning will never be found under the sun

Ecclesiastes 1:7, 9(NIV)

7 What do people gain from all their labors
at which they toil under the sun?

9 What has been will be again,
what has been done will be done again;
there is nothing new under the sun.

“If I find in myself a desire which no experience in this world can satisfy, the most probable explanation is that I was made for another world.”

C. S. Lewis - Mere Christianity